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Sara C. Lemon, UT Community News Audio Editor

October 20, 2026

LA City Council District 3 Candidates: Barri Worth Girvan (left) and Tim Gaspar (right). Barri Worth Girvan photo by: Yauna Olmstead and Tim Gaspar photo by: Robyn Richardson

Business owner Timothy Gaspar and longtime government worker Barri Worth Girvan are vying for the Los Angeles City Council District 3 seat.

After serving three terms, council member Bob Blumenfield will be termed out of the district, which includes a large chunk of the West San Fernando Valley, including the Canoga Park, Reseda, Tarzana, Winnetka, and Woodland Hills neighborhoods.

Both candidates support fully-funded police departments, addressing the homelessness crisis in the area, and have taken stands against state mandates, saying they want what's best for the existing community and to ensure the community has a voice.

Barri Worth Girvan

The candidates differ in a few areas. Worth Girvan's policy platform emphasizes more interim housing and treatment beds for people who need them, wraparound mental health services and a transparent system to track outcomes of programs that serve people experiencing homelessness actually need them.

Girvan has held staff positions in the California State Legislature, the office of former Los Angeles Mayor Antonio Villaraigosa and local county offices, according to the Los Angeles Times.

"My years of experience in the public sector will ensure that I can best navigate City Hall to advocate for the district's interests. Delivering core city services is my bread and butter," Worth Girvan told the Times. "Delivering core city services is my bread and butter…If your trash isn't picked up, if your trees aren't trimmed, if your street lights aren't working, if you pick up the phone to call 911 and nobody responds, then not only is your neighborhood not safe, but your city is not working for you."

Working in the state Senate, Worth Girvan said on her website that she organized Valley-wide efforts to successfully secure funding for transportation infrastructure and helped lead efforts to rebuild organizations affected by wildfires.

She has strong support from environmental advocates and major labor unions, according to the L.A. Times. Her endorsements include more than one dozen labor unions, including SEIU Local 721, International Brotherhood of Electrical Workers Local 11, National Union of Healthcare Workers , American Federation of Teachers (AFT Local 1521 Faculty Guild) and the Communications Workers of America , according to her website. Other supporters include the National Women's Political Caucus - San Fernando Valley, Women's Political Committee of Los Angeles, Abundant Housing LA and Sierra Club. She is also supported by the Democratic Party in Los Angeles County and the San Fernando Valley and the Democratic group for the LGBTQ community, called the Stonewell Democratic Club, the Los Angeles County Young Democrats and the Democrats for Israel Los Angeles group. Other supporters include Los Angeles County District 3 Supervisor Lindsey Horvath; and California State Assembly Majority Whip Mark

González, Assembly Democratic Caucus Chair Rick Chavez Zbur and California Assemblymembers Jesse Gabriel, Nick Schultz, Celeste Rodriguez, Jacqui Irwin, Mike Fong and Pilar Schiavo.

Timothy Gaspar

Timothy Gaspar, who started his own independent insurance firm, has worked with several local nonprofit and civic organizations, including the Metropolitan YMCA of Los Angeles, the Woodland Hills/Warner Center Chamber of Commerce and on the board of trustees of a private school in Calabasas, according to his campaign website.

Gaspar also said he supports encampment cleanups, saying that they need to be cleaned up “swiftly and humanely.”

Gaspar said the city council could benefit from his business experience to counter members whose backgrounds are mostly in public policy or community organizing.

“They’re missing the business perspective,” he told the L.A. Times.

Sergei Goldstein, a Valley resident and a security guard at a Los Angeles Public Library, said he supports Gaspar partly because he knows him personally.

“He helps out. He goes around checking with the homeless and makes sure there‘s a place for them to go and, health-wise, if they‘re OK [since they’re on] the streets,” said Goldstein, who met Gaspar in high school through a mutual friend. “That can help a lot for a community.”

Gaspar has a huge lead in fundraising, reporting more than $180,000 in donations to his runoff campaign through June 30, compared with about $31,000 for Worth Girvan.

Gasper is endorsed by Blumenfield and LA City Councilmember Monica Rodriguez, Tim McOsker and John Lee, as well as California Assemblymember Jacqui Irwin, D-Thousand Oaks, and U.S. Rep. Luz Rivas, D-North Hollywood, Los Angeles County Supervisor Kathryn Barger, Former Los Angeles City Controller Laura Chick, who previously served as an LA City Councilmember for District 3, and former State Senator Robert Hertzberg, according to Ballotpedia.

Gaspar is also backed by groups including the Apartment Association of Greater Los Angeles, Southland Regional Association of Realtors, IBEW Local 18, IBEW Local 40, UA250, Painters and Allied Trades DC36, LASPMA and ILWU13, according to his website. Other supporters include law enforcement groups such as the Los Angeles Police Protective League, Los Angeles County Professional Peace Officers’ Association, Los Angeles Airport Peace Officers Association and the Association for Los Angeles Deputy Sheriffs, and Democratic groups such as Avance Democratic Club, Democratic Municipal Officials, and Blue Wave Democratic Club. VICA, the Valley Industry & Commerce Association, and the Israeli-American Civic Action Network also support him.

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